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Support For B.P.P. President Grows

HUEY P. NEWTON DEFENSE FUND DRIVE TAKES SHAPE

Huey P. Newton, Founder and chief theoretician of the Black Panther Party (BPP), has returned from Cuba to stand trial in Oakland, California, against the false criminal charges largely responsible for initially forcing him into three years of political exile. His decision to return at this time and risk possible life imprisonment rather than continue to live freely and safely in the Republic of Cuba is, of course, the best refutation that the \$100,000 bail sought by the prosecutor and presently set by the court, is confiscatory and unjustifiable. It is also, as a brief review of the facts surrounding his departure and return will show, a personally courageous and politically correct decision.

BACKGROUND

In August, 1974, when Huey P. Newton disappeared for several months to later surface in Cuba, only certain facts were known and others suspected. The Black Panther Party then enjoyed wide support in the Black community of Oakland, California, which it had declared a "base of operation" only two years before, when Huey was released from prison after reversal of a conviction for shooting a



Black Panther Party Founder and President HUEY P. NEWTON.

White policeman in 1967. The numerous "Survival Programs" — a Community School for Children, Free Escort and Transportation services for the elderly, and Free Breakfasts for Children, to name but a few implemented under Huey's leadership — were primarily responsible for this support.

Two Black Panther Party members, Bobby Seale and Elaine Brown, had recently run for mayoralty and city council seats and garnered impressive votes (38 per cent of the total for Seale and 43 per cent for Brown) indicative of substantial community support.

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Blacks Denounce F.B.I. Director—Designate

WEBSTER WON'T RESIGN FROM WHITE CLUBS

(Washington, D.C.) - Blasted by Black groups as a modern day "Adolf Hitler," FBI Director-designate William Webster last week refused to resign from four all-White social clubs to which he belongs.

During two days of testimony at the Senate Judiciary Committee's confirmation hearings, Webster, a federal appellate court judge in St. Louis, said he had no plans to resign from the White social clubs.

Grudgingly admitting, "I suppose I have always been aware that they (clubs) had no Black members," the 53-year-old judge claimed that, "I am as color-blind as any man in this room."

Webster's memberships in the Noonday Club, the Mysterious Order of the Veiled Prophets, the St. Louis Country Club and the University Club have been severely attacked by civil rights groups in St. Louis and by Blacks across the country.

Testifying before the Judiciary Committee on January 31, Ms. Jacqueline Bell, vice chairperson of ACTION, a human rights



FBI Director-designate WILLIAM WEBSTER.

organization in St. Louis, angrily said:

"After what this man (Webster) said yesterday he would have indicted himself before the United Nations as a war criminal. But no, you will confirm him because most of you are infested with the same disease as Webster.

"And one racist institution will always serve the interest of another racist institution. At this point, you would confirm Adolf Hitler for the FBI directorship."

In what the *New York Times* described as "skillfully navigated" testimony, Webster explained that action on any illegal activities of FBI agents would have to be decided by the Justice Department.

In cases where FBI regulations rather than criminal laws were violated, he added that he would report such violations and take disciplinary action.

The federal judge, appointed to the bench in 1970 by ex-President Richard Nixon, made the

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